



Interview Prep Guide



Technology Programs - Power Day Interview

Congratulations on your upcoming interview day with Capital One! We've been impressed with your background so far, and we can't wait to continue the conversation with you. This is the time to show us who you are and the unique perspectives and skills you bring to work. It's also a great opportunity to learn more about us—so don't be afraid to ask questions!

But first, we want to help set you up for success. This guide outlines what to expect and how to prepare for your upcoming round of interviews. If you have any questions, don't hesitate to reach out to your recruiter—they're happy to help.

Need to request accommodations for your interview?

Our Recruiting Accommodations team is here for you. Call us at 1-800-304-9102 or email RecruitingAccommodation@capitalone.com. All information you provide will be kept confidential and will be used only to the extent required to provide the support you need.

Thanks again for your interest in Capital One. Best of luck!

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What to expect during the interview process

Excited for your Power Day? We are too. Here's what you can expect.

Interview schedule

You'll complete 3 interviews:

- 1, 60 minute [Case - Tech Code Based](#)
- 1, 60 minute [Technical Interview - TDP](#)
- 1, 60 minute [Behavioral Interview](#)

The order of your interviews may vary depending on interviewer availability. We'll email you a schedule with the final timing and order of your interviews the day before your Power Day.

Your schedule will also include who your interviewers are, so you'll know who you're meeting with for each session. One thing to note: There might be times when an interviewer-in-training joins your conversation. If that happens, they'll just be there as an observer.

Interviews may not last the full time they're allotted, and that's okay! You're welcome to use any remaining time to ask your interviewers follow-up questions. Remember, this is a two-way conversation, and it's important for you to interview us, too. It's a good idea to come prepared with a few questions to help you learn more about the role, the work and our culture.

During any breaks you may have, feel free to check your email, review your notes or just relax. The time between interviews is yours—we recommend spending it doing whatever makes you feel at your best.

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What to expect during the interview process

Using Zoom

Any interview designated as virtual will take place using Zoom. For virtual interviews, please plan to be on video for the duration of your interviews. If there are extenuating circumstances that might prevent you from being on camera the whole time, let your recruiter or interview scheduling coordinator know as soon as possible.

Check out the [Zoom tips](#) included in this guide if you need any refreshers.

What to wear

Dress to impress, but there's no hard-and-fast dress code. We recommend dressing business casual to business professional—think button-down shirt and slacks, dresses or suit separates. Reach out to your recruiter if you need more info.

Materials

It's not required, but feel free to have notetaking materials close by. That way, you can jot down any thoughts and questions throughout your interviews.

If you need a specific tool for an interview, we'll call that out in the deep-dive section about that interview type. (Your interviewer will also help make sure you have the necessary tools on the day of your interview.)

It's you and your work we care about—so leave the outside noise behind. To maintain the integrity of the interview process, complete your interviews independently without assistance from other people, third parties or external resources (e.g., generative AI or third-party applications). Capital One reserves the right to monitor these activities. Any type of unapproved assistance will disqualify you from further consideration.

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Deep dive: Case Tech - Code Based

During this interactive interview, we'll ask you to solve a business problem that focuses on applied problem solving and coding—just like the ones you might encounter in this role. You'll work with your interviewer to examine a broad business scenario, break down each aspect of the problem and come up with a solution together.

This interview has three parts:

Part 1: Introduction to business situation and case framework

- Your case interview will start with a brief description of the business situation.
- Then, you'll receive some background information and data regarding the problem.
- After the introduction, you may be asked to make some key observations about the situation or identify issues you'll need to consider as you dive further into the case.

Part 2: Coding

- After a general introduction to the case, your interviewer will present you with code in the context of the business situation.
- You may be asked to work through, evaluate or enhance the code.
- You won't need to run code, but you will need to demonstrate an understanding of how it works and interpret the outputs.
- Be ready to answer follow-up questions about your conclusions, including how they may affect aspects of the case.

Part 3: Your recommendation

- Throughout the entire case, the interviewer will ask for your recommendations. It's okay if these change as you're presented with additional data and information.
- At the end of the case, we'll ask you to share a final recommendation, observation or code enhancements.

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Deep dive: Case - Tech Code Based

We typically conduct code-based cases in Java, JavaScript or Python, though you may be able to choose from additional languages. This interview requires the [CodeSignal application](#).

What we're looking for

We're primarily interested in your abilities to understand code, communicate effectively and solve problems in an applied business context.

How to prepare

When your interview kicks off, your interviewer will provide instructions on how to sign in to and use the CodeSignal platform. If you'd like to familiarize yourself with CodeSignal ahead of time or get a quick refresher, check it out at <https://codesignal.com/>.

Get more practice with case interviews

Watch prep videos

Explore our [interview prep playlist on YouTube](#).

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Deep dive: Technical Interview - TDP

For this coding-focused technical interview, you'll participate in different code reviews or exercises in your choice of Java, TypeScript/JavaScript, Go or Python (other programming languages are available upon request). We'll also ask you to show us how you work with data and data schemas.

This interview requires the [CodeSignal application](#).

What we're looking for

Choose a programming language you feel confident working in. This is your time to showcase your technical knowledge and capabilities at their best.

As you work through the exercises, remember to think aloud. This interview isn't just about the solutions you provide. Articulating how you arrived at your answer and sharing your thought process is just as important.

Finally, be open and adaptable to feedback. The ability to recognize and fix mistakes is key to succeeding in the role—and in your interview.

How to prepare

In addition to reviewing the topics above, you may also want to refresh yourself on the CodeSignal platform, which you can access at <https://codesignal.com/>.

When your interview kicks off, your interviewer will provide instructions on how to sign in to and use CodeSignal. If you have any questions in the meantime, reach out to your recruiter for help.

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Deep dive: Behavioral Interview

Behavioral interviews help us learn more about your practical experience and skills. We'll ask you to describe specific situations you've navigated, and questions typically follow the format of, "tell me about a time when..."

What we're looking for

Behavioral interviews can explore a range of skills including—but not limited to—communication, influencing others, collaboration or driving a project from start to finish.

We highly recommend using the STAR method to structure your answer. We want you to be able to share a clear, detailed story about the process of making a decision, completing a task or overcoming an obstacle. Pull it all together by telling us about the results of your actions and what you learned from the experience.

Remember, your real experiences make the most powerful answers. We prefer that you talk about actual examples rather than hypothetical situations. And if you're not immediately sure how to answer a question, pause—don't panic. It's perfectly acceptable to ask your interviewer for a moment to gather your thoughts before diving in.

The STAR method

Situation or task

Describe the situation that you were in or the task that you needed to accomplish.

- Describe a specific event or situation, not a generalized description of what you've done in the past.
- Be sure to give enough detail for the interviewer to understand the situation and your role in it.

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Deep dive: Behavioral Interview

Action

Describe the action you took, and be sure to focus on you.

- Even if you're discussing a group project or effort, try to focus on what *you* did, rather than the efforts of other team members.
- Don't describe what you might do in your examples; describe your real actions—even if things didn't go as planned. Talking about how you handled missteps or unforeseen challenges can be a great way to demonstrate your problem-solving skills.

Results

Don't forget to conclude your answer with the result of your actions.

- What happened?
- How did the event end?
- What did you accomplish?
- What did you learn

How to prepare

Brainstorm different scenarios ahead of time to have the details fresh in your mind.

Draw on examples from past jobs, volunteer or pro bono work, school projects or similar experiences. Try to have a couple different examples that showcase each capability or skill you want to highlight.

Practice the STAR method with these sample behavioral questions. Just remember: These examples aren't the exact questions you'll be asked during your interview. However, they address similar themes.

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Deep dive: Behavioral Interview

Tell me about a time when...

- You used persuasion to successfully convince someone to see things your way.
- You used good judgment and logic when solving a problem.
- You had to go above and beyond the call of duty to get a job done.
- You had too many things to do and you were required to prioritize your tasks.
- You anticipated potential problems and developed preventive measures.

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After you finish your interviews

First things first, congratulate yourself on completing your interview day!

After your last interview is complete, your recruiter will contact you within 5 to 7 business days to let you know the outcome. If a hiring decision is expected to take longer, your recruiter will let you know.

Keep in mind, your recruiter will not be able to provide specific feedback about your interview results.

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Zoom instructions and tips

We use Zoom to conduct our virtual interviews. Virtual interviews allow you to complete your interviews from the comfort of home, plus they provide a more flexible experience for you and your interviewers alike.

Please plan to be on video for the duration of your interviews. If there are extenuating circumstances that might prevent you from being on camera the whole time, let your recruiter or interview scheduling coordinator know as soon as possible.

Tips

- Join your designated Zoom meeting a few minutes early so you have time to settle in and troubleshoot, if needed
- Set your devices to “do not disturb”
 - Put your phone on silent
 - Close all other computer programs and turn off notifications that may cause disruptions
- Get ready for your close-up
 - Zoom from somewhere with minimal background noise
 - Sit in front of a neutral background—let yourself be the focus!
 - Make sure there’s plenty of light

Tech check

- Check that your browser version up to date (Zoom supports all major browsers)
- Use a webcam with reliable internet connection
- Make sure your computer is fully charged, or have a charger close by
- Test or update Zoom at least 1 hour prior to interviews starting
 - If you experience issues with the audio, dial in from a cell phone or landline and use your computer for video

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Zoom instructions and tips

Joining your interviews

1. Launch Zoom
2. Check your audio (speakers and microphone) by joining [a test meeting invitation](#)
 - a. Follow prompts to test your speakers (you will hear a ringtone)
 - b. Follow prompts to test your microphone (speak, pause and listen to your replay)
3. After you've tested your audio, select "Join Meeting" in the Zoom application
4. Enter the meeting ID (and password, if prompted), which you'll find in your final interview schedule
5. Choose your audio and video settings
6. Once you make your selections, you'll be connected with your interviewers
7. Remember: We're excited to learn more about you—you've got this!

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Capital One resources

Get to know us

Learn about Capital One's history and check out the latest news:

- [History and mission](#)
- [Newsroom and company updates](#)

Explore life at Capital One

Immerse yourself in our mission, values, culture and more!

- [Culture](#)
- [Benefits](#)
- [Diversity, inclusion and belonging](#)
- [How we work](#)
- [Hybrid model](#)
- [Innovation](#)
- [Careers blog](#)

Our core competencies

Competencies are the demonstrated skills and behaviors necessary for effective job performance at Capital One. They set the bar for how we work and show up each and every day. Though each role and job family has its own key skills and benchmarks for success, every associate at Capital One focuses on these competencies:

- Communication
- Customer focus
- Influence
- Judgment
- Lives the values
- Problem solving
- Results focused
- Teamwork